

Technical and Business Writing

Project (Phase_I): Proposal Writing

Project Overview

You are required to develop a formal proposal for designing and developing a website for a campus club or company division. Your proposal should address an existing issue (such as lack of online visibility, difficulty in member communication, or inefficiency in resource management) and provide a well-researched, structured solution. The proposal must be based on research (primarily primary research including at least 10 surveys or 3 interviews from the relevant audience) and written for a decision-making audience (e.g., club presidents, department heads, or business managers).

This is a **group project**, and each group must have **3 to 4 members**. All members are expected to contribute equally, and the final proposal must reflect collaboration.

Your proposal must include persuasive, research-driven content to help the audience make an informed decision. The content should be **original**, and any **similarity exceeding 20%** (excluding references) will be flagged for plagiarism. **Identical content or copied data across groups will result in a grade of F.**

Proposal Structure

Your proposal must follow a professional structure and include the following elements:

1. Title Page

- Proposal Title
- Group Member Names & Student IDs
- Course Name & Instructor Name
- Submission Date
- Target Audience (e.g., club president, company manager)

2. Cover Letter / Cover Memo

- Addressed to the decision-maker
- Brief overview of the proposal
- Key benefits of the proposed website
- Request for consideration and next steps

3. Table of Contents (TOC)

- List of sections and corresponding page numbers

4. List of Illustrations

- Tables, charts, diagrams, or any visual elements used in the proposal

5. Abstract / Executive Summary

- A concise summary (3-5 sentences) covering:
 - The issue being addressed
 - The proposed website solution
 - Expected benefits and impact

6. Introduction

- **Overview:** Briefly introduce the need for a digital presence.
- **Background:** Discuss the current state and why a website is necessary.
- **Problem Statement:** Clearly define the issue (e.g., lack of online presence, outdated website, inefficient communication).
- **Needs:** Explain why a new website is the best solution.
- **Scope:** Outline what the website will include (features, functionalities, limitations).

7. Body (Proposed Plan)

- **Methods:** Describe the approach to designing and developing the website.
 - Website technologies (e.g., HTML, CSS, JavaScript, WordPress, CMS)
 - Features (e.g., login system, event calendar, forum, blog, contact forms)
 - Development methodology (Agile, Waterfall, etc.)
- **Costs:** Breakdown of costs, including:
 - Domain & Hosting
 - Development & Maintenance Costs
 - Any additional expenses
- **Feasibility & Advantages:**
 - Justify why your proposal is realistic
 - Benefits of having the website (e.g., increased engagement, efficient management, brand credibility)
- **Personnel:** Explain the roles of group members and their contributions.
- **Projections / Forecasts:** If applicable, predict potential user engagement, growth, or impact over time.

8. Conclusion

- Summary of the proposal's key points
- Final persuasive statement
- Call to action (e.g., request for approval, next steps)

9. Glossary (if needed)

- Define technical terms for non-technical decision-makers.

10. Works Cited

- Cite all sources in APA/MLA format.

11. Appendix (if necessary)

- Any extra supporting materials (e.g., survey results, design mockups).
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Drafting Guidelines

- **Follow the standard proposal format** discussed in class (refer to Week 11 materials on GCR).
 - **Use structured headings:**
 - **Title:** Arial or Verdana, 18 pt
 - **Heading Level 1:** Arial or Verdana, 14 pt, Bold
 - **Heading Level 2:** Arial or Verdana, 12 pt, Bold
 - **Heading Level 3:** Arial or Verdana, 11 pt, Italic
 - **Body Text:** Times New Roman, 12 pt, or Calibri, 11 pt
 - **Apply good document design principles:** Balance, alignment, consistency, grouping, and contrast.
 - **Enhance readability** with visuals like charts, tables, and mockups.
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Submission Guidelines

1. Softcopy Submission (on GCR)

- **Deadline:** Wednesday, April 23, 2025
- **Format:** Single consolidated document (Word or PDF)
- **Submission:** Only one group member needs to submit on GCR

File Naming Convention (Mandatory)

To ensure uniformity, follow the **naming convention**. **Failure to do so will result in a 2-mark deduction.**

- [StudentID]/*FirstName*/[LastName]_TBW Project

§ **Example:** 22K-1234_Ali_Khan_TBW Project.pdf

2. Printed Submission

- **Deadline:** Thursday, April 24, 2025
- **Submission Details:**
 - Submit the printed proposal to your **CR before 1:00 PM.**

- The CR will submit all collected proposals to **Office B-220 by 3:00 PM.**
- Attach a **printed rubric** with the hardcopy.

△ **No late submissions (soft or printed) will be accepted.**

Expectations & Plagiarism Policy

- **Use real, research-based data** to support your proposal.
- **Similarity beyond 20%** with external sources (excluding references) will be flagged for review.
- **Identical ideas or content across groups** will be treated as plagiarism and result in marks deduction.
- **Reusing content from other courses** (in part or full) or submitting this proposal elsewhere will result in a **grade of F**.